

Symbian^3

The Symbian community has released the newest version of Symbian, version 3 with over 250 new features

Symbian members

Prominent telcos such as AT&T, NTT Docomo, Qualcomm, Sony Ericsson, Samsung and Vodafone, in addition to its known promoter Nokia are members of the Symbian Foundation

The latest browsers: Opera 10.6 vs. Firefox 4 Beta 1

Opera 10.60

With the advent of Opera 10.60, Opera Software is bringing the versions of Opera for all platforms in sync and thereby offering better stability and a further 50% boost in terms of performance. The standard SunSpider test has revealed that Opera 10.60's performance is at par with that of Chrome 6's latest dev version. It is also twice as fast as the latest Firefox 4 build, and almost thrice as fast as Firefox's latest stable version 3.6.6. While the SunSpider test alone isn't enough to gauge the performance of all aspects of the browser, there seems to be a pattern here.

Opera 10.60 also comes with better support for upcoming standards, including Geolocation, and it is the first stable browser to support WebM media. Other standard features include App-Cache, for offline applications and Web Workers. There are a few more tweaks to the Opera

UI and features which improve the browser overall, the Opera menu being one of them. Additionally, Opera features such as the download tab, history tab etc. now display icons instead of tab previews. Another subtle change is the inclusion of Bing as a search engine in the browser – although Google is still the default. Opera



10.60 also supports search suggestions from websites such as Wikipedia.

Opera 10.60 no longer shows tab previews in the Windows 7 taskbar. While the feature has its utility, for many power users

it is simply an annoyance, since the whole point of browser tabs was to not clutter the taskbar. Those who still want to turn it on needn't worry. The option is still there.

Opera 10.60 also brings new security features in the form of an "AVG-supported anti-fraud systems and phishing protection". This is coupled with live feeds which carry information educating users of current scams, and potential malware.

Although Opera 10.60 further evolves Opera towards a perfect browser, it misses one of the key things – the out of process model for plugins, now adopted by Chrome and Firefox 4.

Firefox 4 Beta 1

Firefox Beta 1 will be a very early look at Firefox 4, and will feature few of the brilliant features that will be found in the final release. They are as follows:

1. New UI with add-on manager.



2. Windows 7 taskbar integration.

3. Support for jumplists and tab previews (which unlike most other browsers can be turned off).

4. Implements tabs-on-top approach with the UI. But, this could be changed from tabs on top to tabs on bottom if desired.

5. Adds an HTML5 parser and full support for web video, audio, and drag and drop.

However, there is precious little improvement in web forms support, and the browsers lags significantly behind Opera 10.6 in terms of performance.

Microsoft and Facebook open Docs.com

Docs.com, a collaborative effort between Facebook and Microsoft, has been opened to the general public. Meant to allow users to create and share Microsoft Office documents over Facebook, Microsoft has unveiled a new feature soon after its full release: support for Facebook fan pages.

This will allow administrators of Facebook fan pages to use and emplace Office documents,

as supplements to their content. This feature seems unusual, and Microsoft admits that it wasn't initially envisioned as a function of the service: "When we built the service, we didn't anticipate this as a core scenario. We were focused on individuals sharing documents at any point in time."

Commenting about Docs.com as a platform, Pat Kinsel, Product Manager of Docs.com at Microsoft's FUSE Labs, went

on to say that the site has a long way to go before it catches up with Google Docs, which additionally gives users the ability to share and collaborate on non Microsoft Office documents. Other Google Docs advantages according to Kinsel include searchable docs, and the tight integration of Gmail and Google Docs.

But, Kinsel pointed out that revisions are coming out on a weekly basis, and that for now,

"growth isn't the priority; the experience is." Microsoft is also looking for better integration between mail and document sharing, and Kinsel shared that it's a definite milestone on their "roadmap."

"The big open question is whether Facebook users can be leveraged and steered to productivity scenarios, or is this a site where people want to goof off. I think we're at the forefront of finding that out."